



IIT Madras
B.S. Degree

STRATEGIES FOR PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Week 2

Communication and Listening Skills

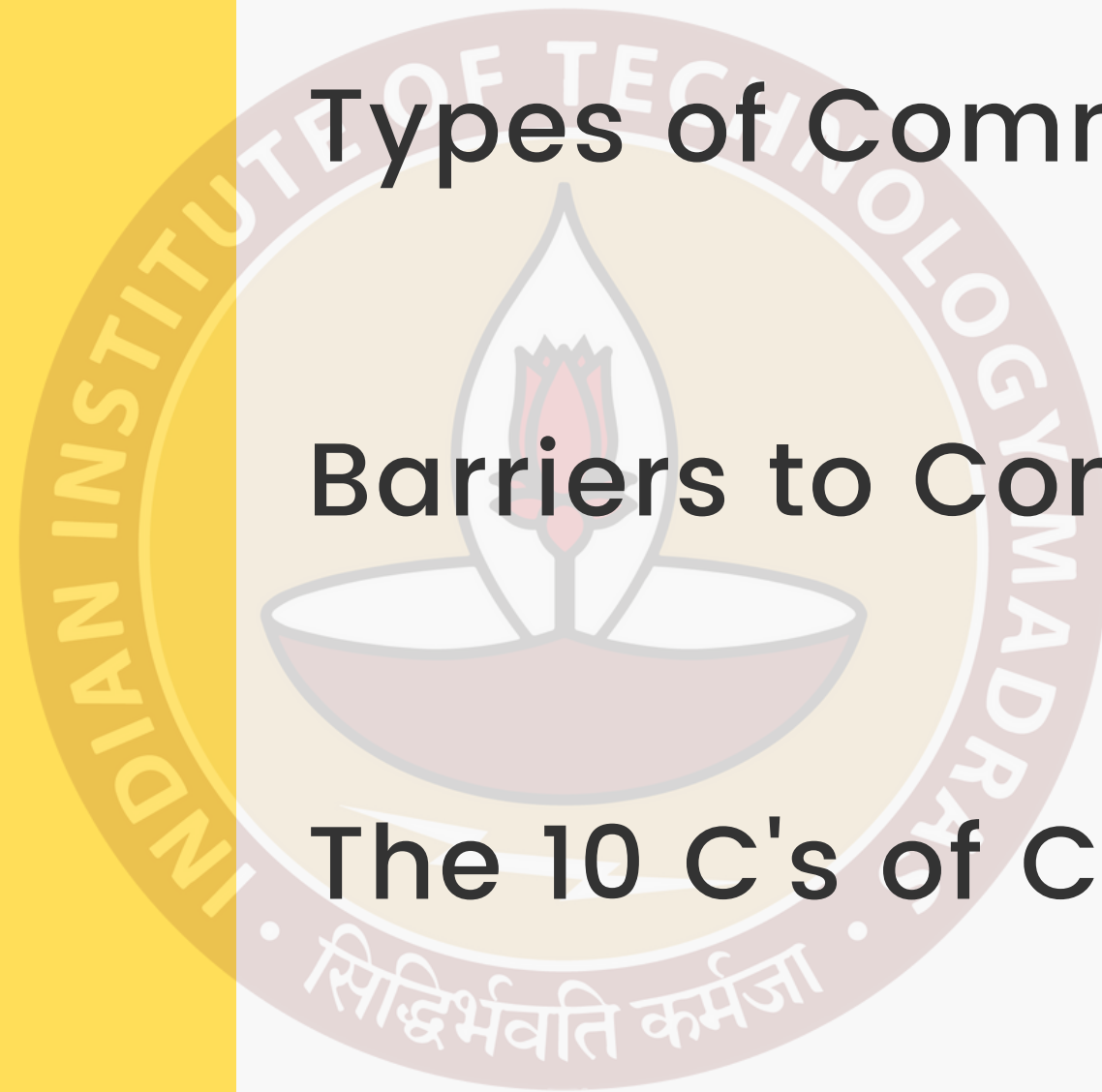


Communication and Listening Skills

Types of Communication

Barriers to Communication

The 10 C's of Communication



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Types of Communication

Types of Communication

- **Inner:** Unexpressed, inner chatter, thinking, imagining, feeling
- **Outer:** Expressed through speech and/or action

Inner vs Outer

- **Personal:** Self, family, friends, near and dear ones
- **Social/Professional:** Community/ Society, associates at workplace

Personal vs Social

- **Verbal:** Spoken word
- **Non-verbal:** Gestures, body language, para lingual

Verbal vs Non-Verbal

- **Written:** Documents, agreement, reports, emails
- **Oral:** Spoken, discussions, opinions

Written vs Oral

- **Internal:** Within the team, org
- **External:** With clients, vendors, other teams

Internal vs External

- **Vertical:** Upwards and downwards in the org/team hierarchy
- **Horizontal:** Peers in same team or across teams

Vertical vs Horizontal

- **Formal:** Reports, briefings, minutes of meeting, feedback, appraisals
- **Informal:** Ad hoc talks/chats over coffee/tea/lunch

Formal vs Informal

Barriers to Communication

10 C's of Communication

Types of Communication

Barriers to Communication

Psychological Barriers

Language Barriers

Cultural Barriers

Organizational Barriers

Physical Barriers

10 C's of Communication

Barriers to Communication

Psychological Barriers



Language Barriers



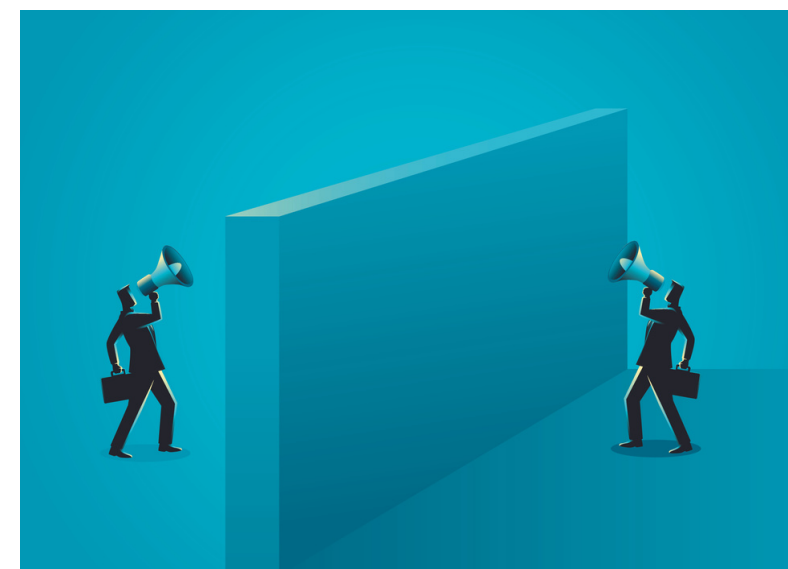
Cultural Barriers



Organizational Barriers



Physical Barriers



Types of Communication

Barriers to Communication

Psychological Barriers

Language Barriers

Cultural Barriers

Organizational Barriers

Physical Barriers

10 C's of Communication

Psychological Barriers

- Inner Chatter
- Preconceived notions
- Cognitive bias
- Lack of interest, attention or focus, boredom
- Emotional state – fears, anxiety, anger
- Limiting Beliefs



Types of Communication

Barriers to Communication

Psychological Barriers

☞ Language Barriers

Cultural Barriers

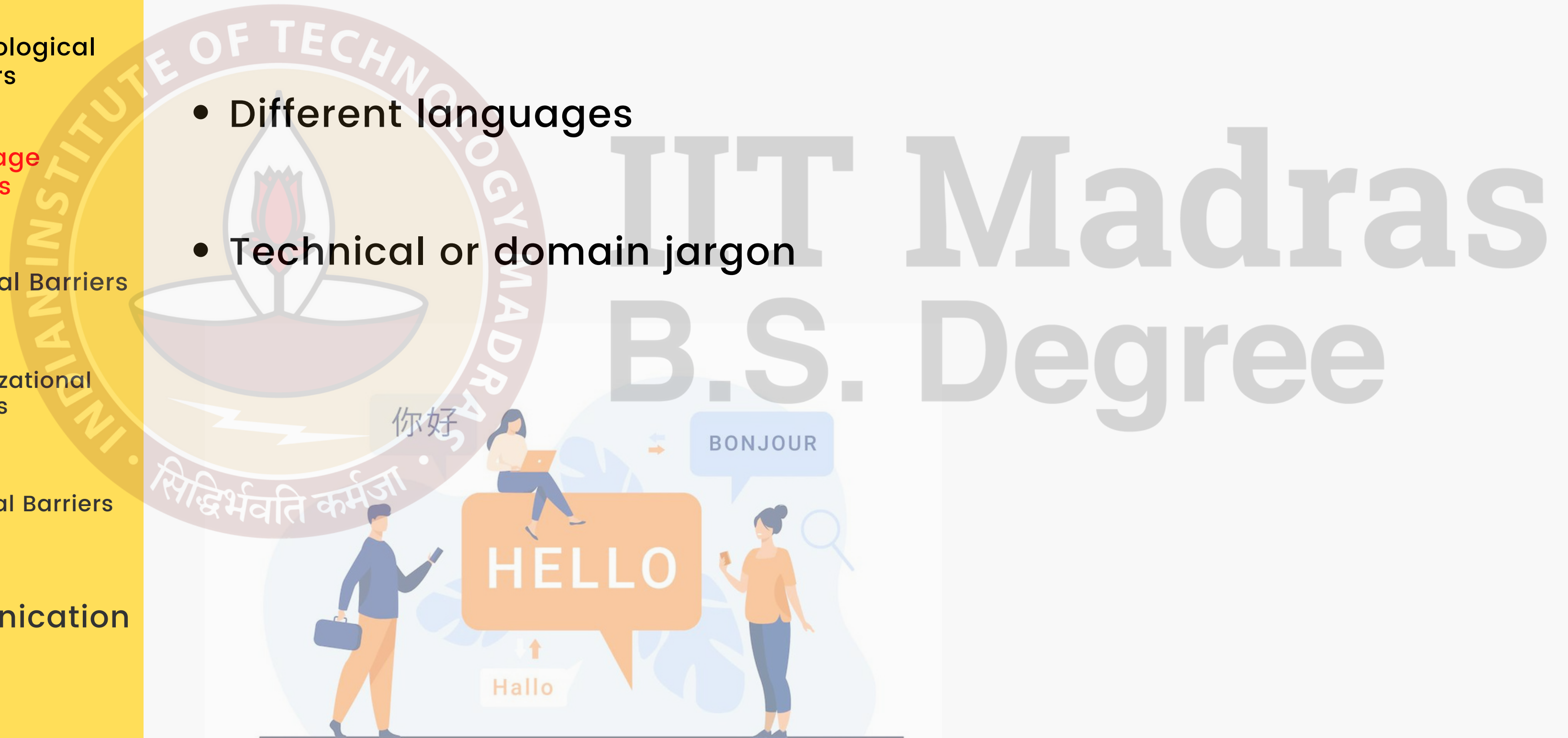
Organizational Barriers

Physical Barriers

10 C's of Communication

Language Barriers

- Complex languages
- Different languages
- Technical or domain jargon



Types of Communication

Barriers to Communication

Psychological Barriers

Language Barriers

👉 Cultural Barriers

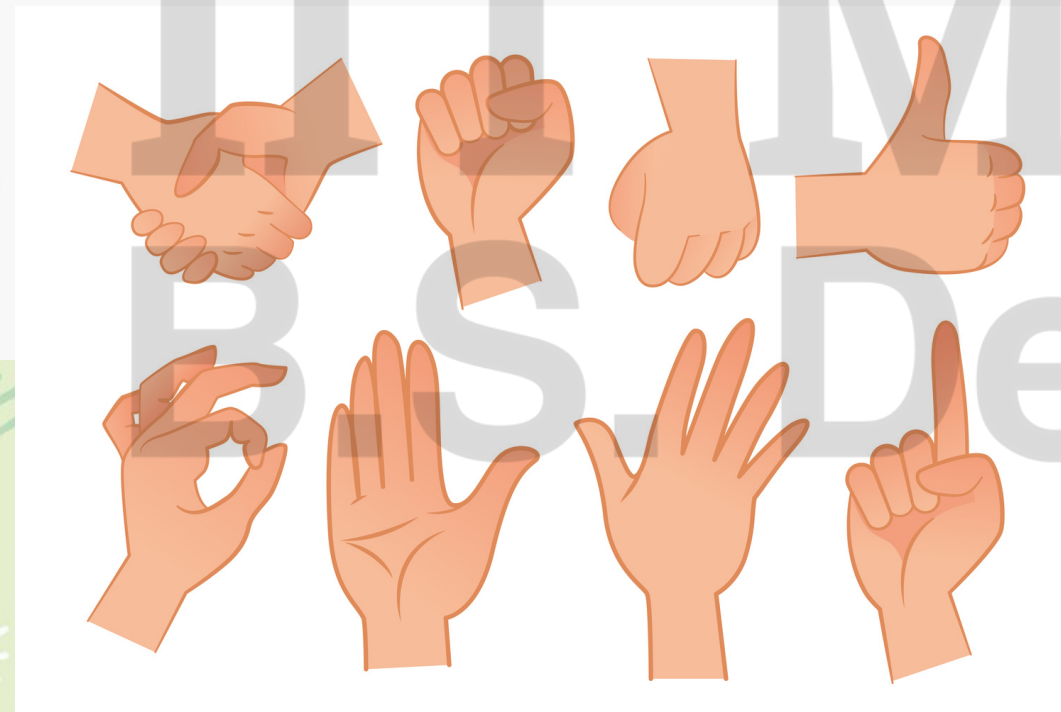
Organizational Barriers

Physical Barriers

10Cs of Effective Communication

Cultural Barriers

- Gestures / signs / words appropriate for one culture, inappropriate for another



Types of Communication

Barriers to Communication

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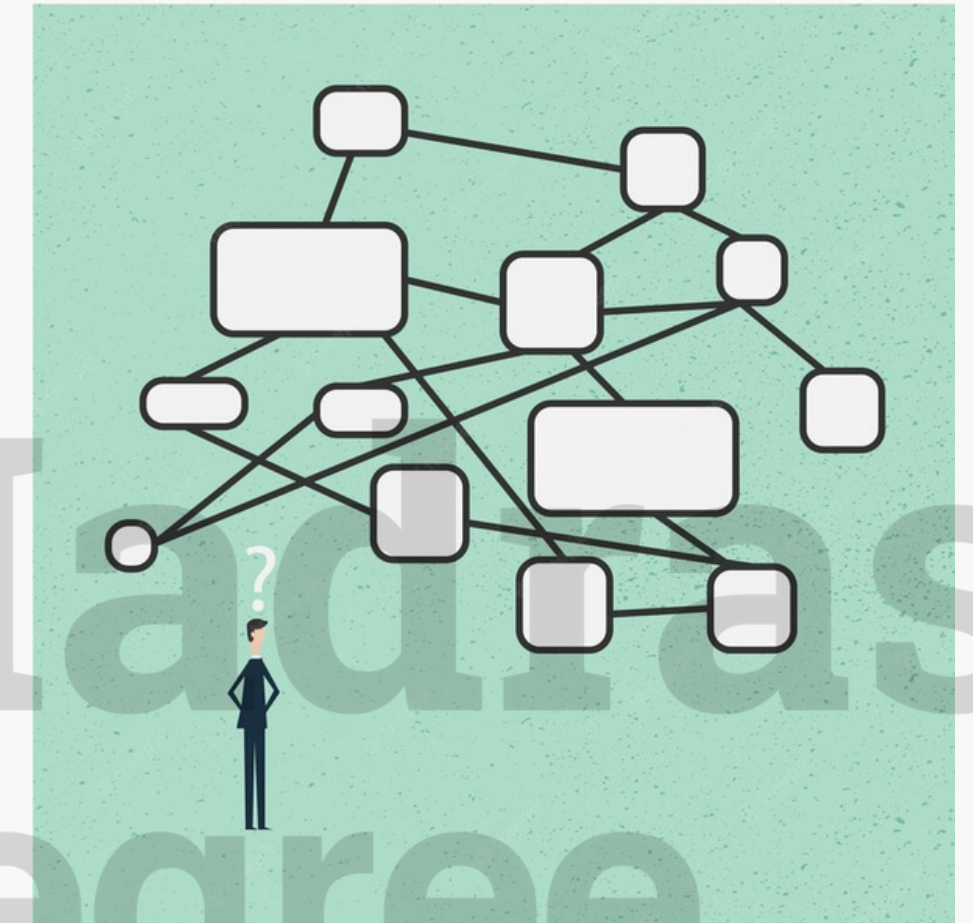
👉 **Organizational Barriers**

Physical Barriers

10 C's of Communication

Organizational Barriers

- Hierarchy may be a barrier to the free flow of communication within the organization
- Complexity of hierarchy or organizational structure can lead to miscommunication/distortion
- Absence of proper communication channels can affect the quality and efficiency of work.
- Official communication channels and informal communication channels (grapevine network) should be clearly distinguished

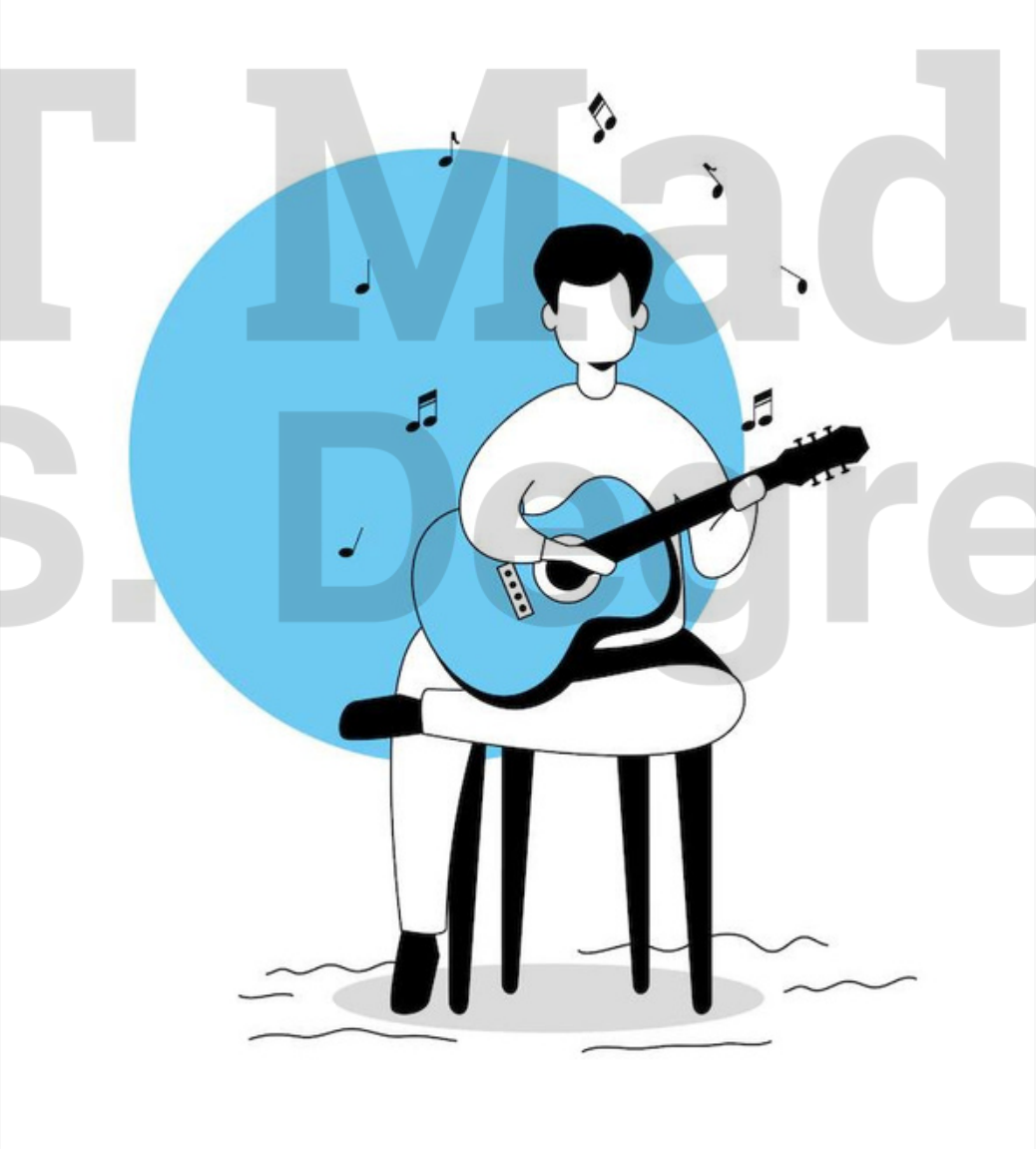


Physical Barriers

- Environment



- Acoustics and Space



Types of Communication

Barriers to Communication

Psychological Barriers

Language Barriers

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Organizational Barriers

👉 **Physical Barriers**

10Cs of Effective Communication

Physical Barriers

- Noise



- Physical Things

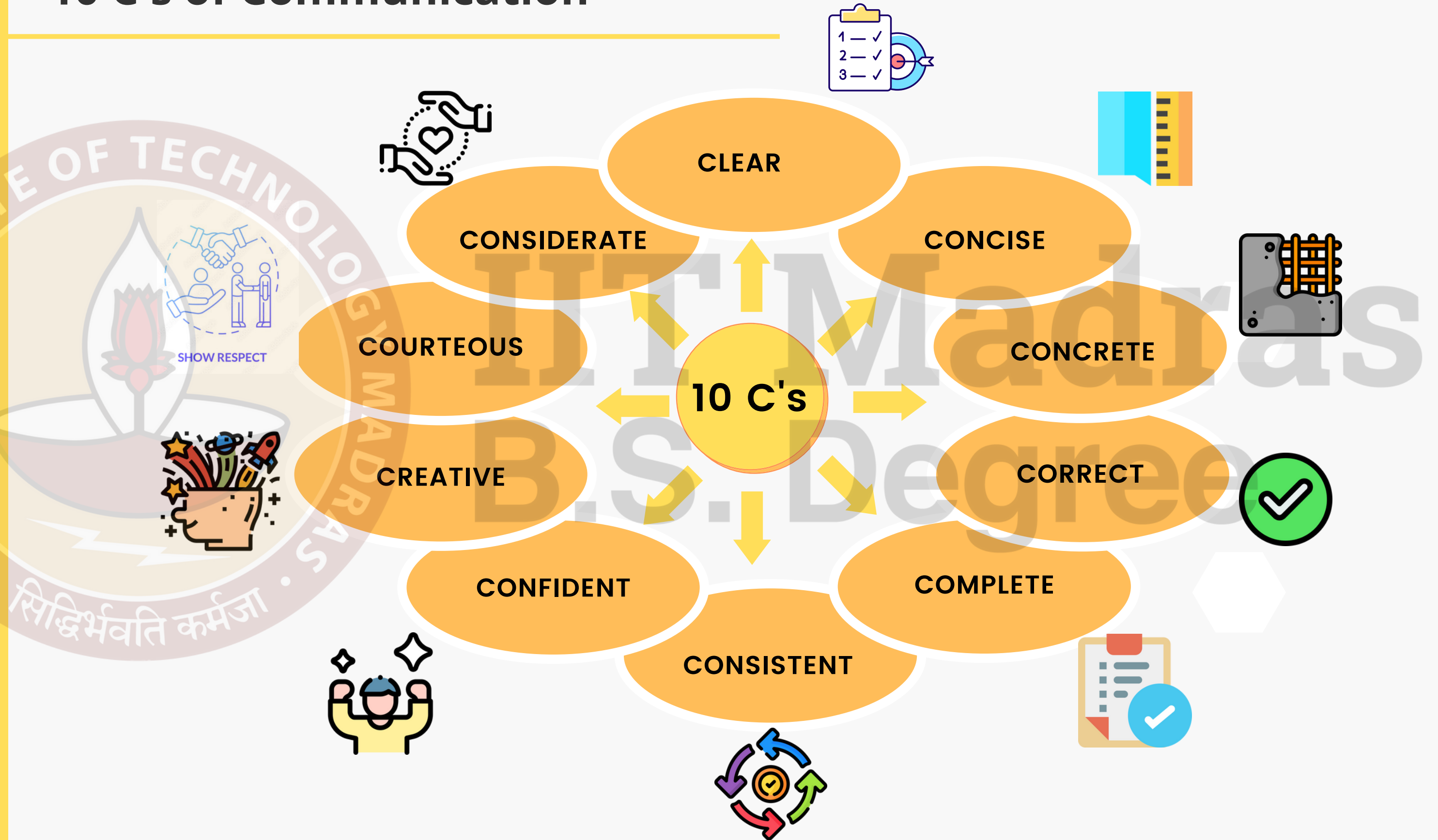


10 C's of Communication

Types of
Communication

Barriers to
Communication

10 C's of
Communication



10 C's of Communication

I. CLEAR/ CLARITY

☞ Clear/ Clarity

Concise/
Conciseness

Concrete/
Concreteness

Correct/
Correctness

Complete/
Completeness

Consistent/
Consistency

Confident/
Confidence

Creative/
Creativity

Courteous/
Courtesy

Considerate/
Consideration

- Wordy sentences
- Vague and ambiguous
- No specific message
- Difficult to understand

“We considered the consequences of the existing policy on risk management strategies we employ with our Risk and Compliance department and updated them accordingly.”

- Clarity in thought and words enhances meaning

- Simple, common words/language

- Clear and specific message

- Easy to understand

“We updated Risk and Compliance policies.”

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II. CONCISE/ CONCISENESS

- Wordy, long
- Redundant and repeating words
- Unnecessary and irrelevant information
- Incomprehensible, Not appealing

“Given that it is COVID, follow necessary precautions for COVID – wear mask and sanitize hands and follow social distancing to ensure all government regulations are followed without fail.”

- Short, clear, brief
- No redundant words and repetition
- Provides essential, necessary and relevant information only
- Easy to understand and is appealing

Mandatory Government
Regulations for COVID

- Wear mask
- Sanitize hands
- Follow social distancing”

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III. CONCRETE/ CONCRETENESS

- Vague, abstract, general
- No supporting data
- Easy to misinterpret

“The sales numbers of ABC team are on the low side. The numbers need to be raised.”

- Accurate and specific facts and figures
- Specific data and proof
- Message doesn't give room for misinterpretation

“The sales conversion rate of ABC team is below 40%. We need to aim for 50% or higher next quarter. Let us plan a strategy meet.”

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IV. CORRECT/ CORRECTNESS

- Grammatical, punctuation and spelling errors

- Inappropriate language and words

- Misrepresented data, facts and figures

“Subsequent to our conservation on monday I wanted to let you know that about 200-300 people have registered for the conference.”

- Correct grammar, punctuation and spelling

- Appropriate and right language

- Correctly represented data, facts and figures

"Subsequent to our conversation on Monday, I wanted to let you know that 200 people have registered for the Data Science Conference."

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V. COMPLETE/ COMPLETENESS

- Incomplete

- Questions may arise, may seek additional information and data

“Monthly system shutdown for maintenance will happen tomorrow. Backup all your work.”

- Message must be complete and to the point

- All data points to be covered and presented

- Covers supporting information that may arise from potential questions

“Monthly system shutdown for maintenance is at 2 p.m. on Sat, Feb 26th, 2022 for 30 minutes. Please backup all your work prior to that.”

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VI. CONSISTENT/ CONSISTENCY

- Inconsistent representation of data and facts
- No communication schedule, no regular communication
- Communication happens only when someone raises a question, concern or there is a conflict

- Message and data must be consistent and continuous to build credibility

- Create a communication schedule if regular updates need to be provided

- Be proactive and responsive

E.g. Create a communication schedule, say every week, an update goes to all team members on what happened that week, important achievements, targets reached etc.

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VII. CONFIDENT/ CONFIDENCE

- Try hard to impress or please

- Nervous, use errs and ummm and aaahs

- Not prepared

I am...errr....actually, I have.....uhh...some important work.....and need some body leave.” (nervous language)

- Be yourself

- Express freely and creatively

- Be firm, assertive and to the point

- Use words of power and positivity

- Practise and Prepare beforehand

“Ravi, I have some important personal work I need to attend to. I would like 2 days of leave on the 24th and 25th.”

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VIII. CREATIVE/ CREATIVITY

- **Monotonous**

**Good morning everyone.
My talk today is on how to
make hay while the sun
shines. The 5 steps to be
followed are...**

- Use humor, wit, stories, quotes

- Be creative and resourceful

- Use creative aids to simplify and create a compelling and attractive message

Good morning everyone!

**Once upon a time there were two
friends. An ant and a cricket...**

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IX. COURTEOUS/ COURTESY

- Rude, impolite

- Words with low and Negative energy, hurtful

- Critical

- Passively aggressive

- Hidden insults

“This is not what it is supposed to be. You are always doing things wrong. Work on it again.”

- Be Humble, sincere, enthusiastic, respectful, honest

- Use words of positive energy

- Appreciative and tactful

- Constructive feedback

“There is some rework that needs to be done. Let's go through the work to see what changes need to be made.”

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X. CONSIDERATE/ CONSIDERATION

- Does not take into consideration the audience

- Self-centered

- Harsh

“I really don't care how. Make all the changes. Get this done asap.”

- Consider feelings, mindset, perspective of audience/ listener

- Seek to understand and empathise

- Solicit Feedback

“Before we go through the changes that need to be made, I would like to understand what challenges you are facing.”



STRATEGIES FOR PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Week II - Communication and Listening Skills

1. In the next video, the speaker will describe the drawing. Listen and draw on a paper.



STRATEGIES FOR PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Week II - Communication and Listening Skills

1. In this video, the speaker will describe the drawing.
Listen and draw on a paper.
2. Mention any one communication barrier that virtual teams must overcome.



Post your drawing and answer in the Discourse



Listening Skills

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by Shiva Subramaniam



“

What is Listening?

- Reducing the noise in your head
- Seeing with your ears

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Passive Listening

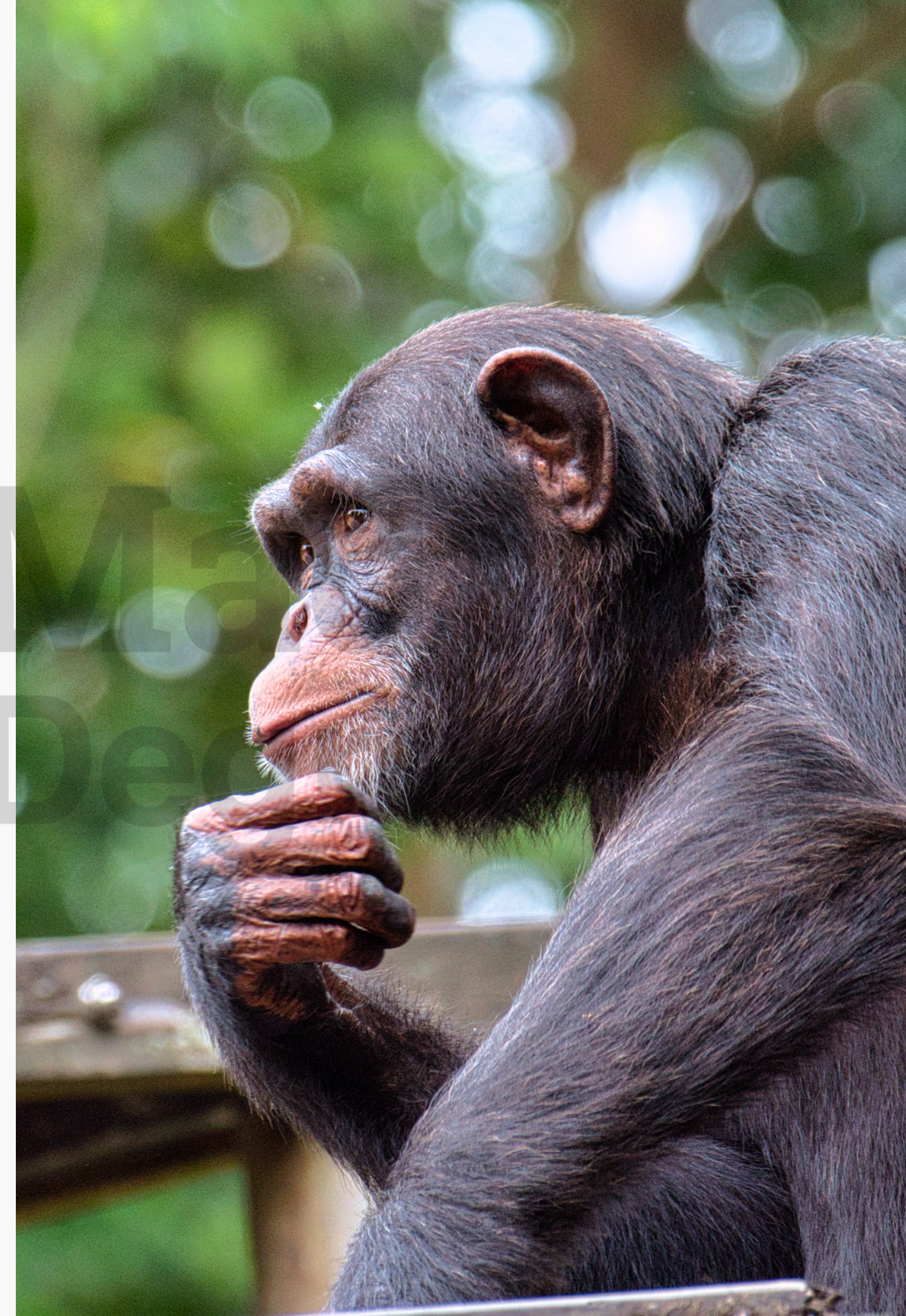
- Listen without interruption
- Listen to the whole person – voice, tone, body language
- Can acknowledge by way of sounds (hmm..), gestures (nodding) to let the other person know you are listening
- Normally used when a person is very distressed



Active Listening

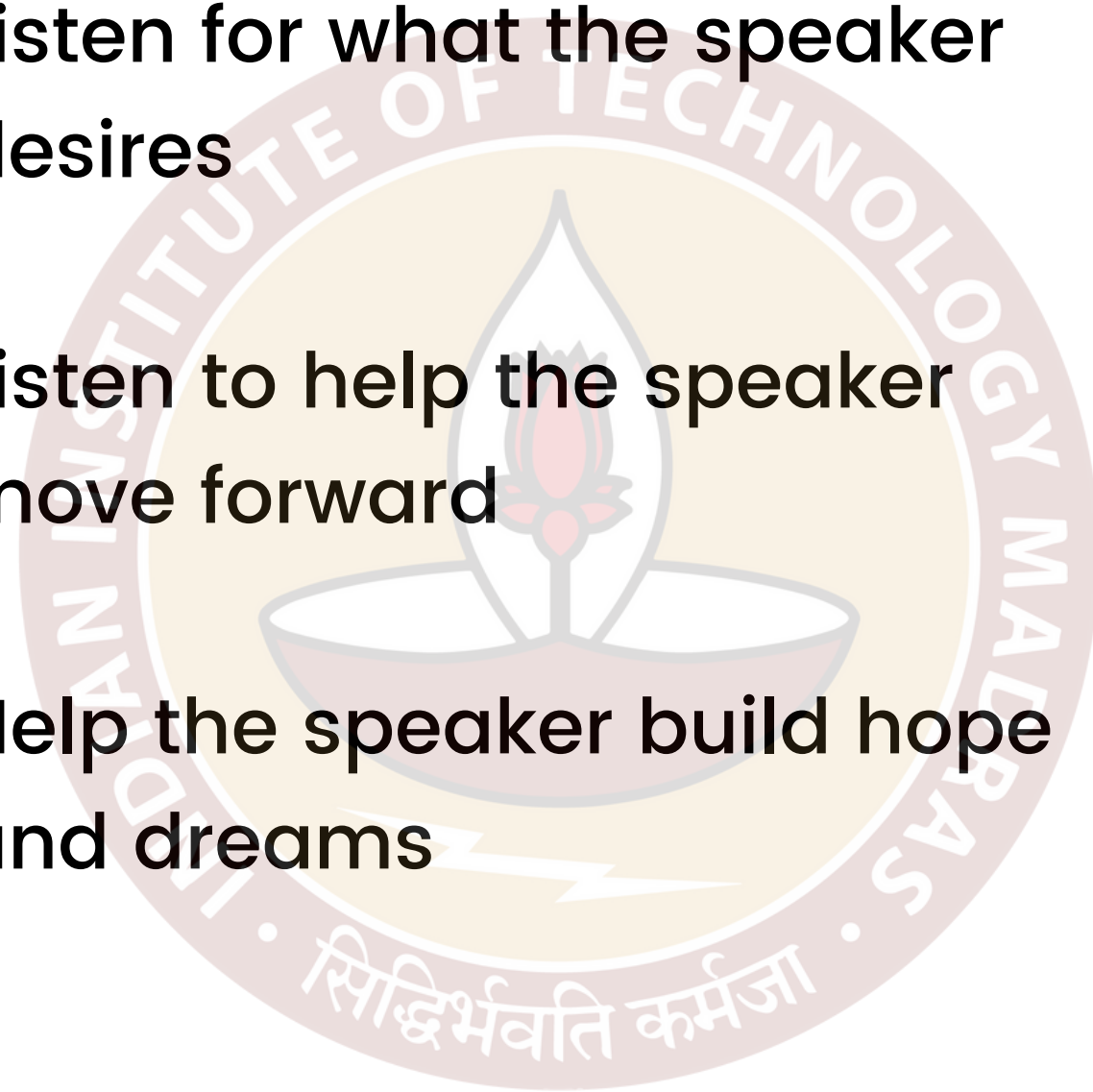
- Listen with animation and acknowledgement
- Paraphrase for understanding
- Ask for clarification
- Ask questions
- Mirror emotions

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Listening to the Future

- Listen for what the speaker desires
- Listen to help the speaker move forward
- Help the speaker build hope and dreams



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5 Ways to Listen Better



The term communication is freely used by everyone in modern society, including members of the general public, organizational behavior scholars, and management practitioners. Despite this widespread usage, very few can precisely define the term. Part of the problem is that communication experts have not agreed on a definition themselves.

Most definitions of communication stress the use of symbols to transfer the meaning of information. Communication is the understanding not of the visible but of the invisible and hidden. These hidden and symbolic elements embedded in the culture give meaning to the visible communication process. Of equal, communication is a personal process that involves the exchange of behaviors and information.

Organizational behavior : An evidence-based approach by Fred Luthans